

Field Guides / Method & books

# What is the S.C.A.L.E. Method?

The S.C.A.L.E. Method is the framework from Den Lennie's 2026 book, and the method every VBA Elite Boardroom member is coached through. S.C.A.L.E. sets out five pillars a video business grows through: Survival (focus on the right markets and projects), Control (nurture 50 to 100 high-value relationships), Alignment (position as a trusted partner, not a vendor), Leverage (build systems so you're not the bottleneck) and Expansion (scale into bigger projects with consistent revenue). The method works out which of the five is your constraint right now and puts the work there.

## What are the five S.C.A.L.E. pillars?

The five S.C.A.L.E. pillars are Survival, Control, Alignment, Leverage and Expansion, the five disciplines a video business grows through.

- **Survival.** Focus on the right markets and projects.
- **Control.** Nurture 50 to 100 high-value relationships.
- **Alignment.** Position as a trusted partner, not a vendor.
- **Leverage.** Build systems so you're not the bottleneck.
- **Expansion.** Scale into bigger projects with consistent revenue.

## How does the S.C.A.L.E. Method decide where to start?

The S.C.A.L.E. Method finds the one pillar that is capping the business right now and puts the work there, one move at a time.

Most owners try to fix a structure problem with more effort: more clients, more gear, more late nights. That adds pressure. The rule is simplify first, systemise second, and never build complex systems on top of chaos. Each pillar has one move that clears the way for the rest, and that move is where the coaching starts.

Owners often place themselves one step further along than they are. That's why the diagnostic looks at what's actually in place in the business (the pricing, the delivery process, who does the editing) rather than how it feels. For Elite Boardroom members, the S.C.A.L.E. Diagnostic on joining maps where the business sits, identifies the constraint holding it there, and finds the one move to make first.

## What does each S.C.A.L.E. pillar look like in a video business?

Each S.C.A.L.E. pillar shows up as a recognisable kind of week, and each has its own first move. Below is what each looks like when it's your constraint, with the free guides that help.

### Survival: focus on the right markets and projects

Survival is the constraint when you are the business: delivery, decisions and income all depend on you, and effort is the growth strategy. Effort has a ceiling. The move is focus: one clear offer, one defined type of client, one repeatable way work comes in, and a minimum project fee you hold. Know which clients and projects actually make money before you change anything.

Guides: [How to price a video project](#), [Why knowing your numbers lets you price with confidence](#), [What to look at in your last twelve months](#), [What your business needs to make](#), [What to say when a prospect asks for a ballpark price](#), [The pricing checklist](#), [The profitable quote checklist](#), [Content or outreach](#).

**Control: nurture 50 to 100 high-value relationships**

Control is the constraint when revenue is growing and so is the complexity: several jobs running, everything coming back to you for approval, and growth that depends on saying yes to almost everything. The move is reliability: pricing logic you've written down and hold, a delivery process on paper rather than in your head, and proof that shows client outcomes. Adding more services or clients to keep the momentum going makes it worse.

Guides: [How many revision rounds to include](#), [The three revision emails](#), [Drop the scope, not the price](#), [Charging for the invisible work](#), [The scope checklist](#), [How to push back on a client without losing them](#), [How to write a follow-up email that gets a reply](#), [How to get more from referrals and networking](#), [Feast or famine](#), [Where to start with better systems](#), [How to plan your year](#).

**Alignment: position as a trusted partner, not a vendor**

Alignment is the constraint when systems exist, some work is delegated and revenue is predictable, yet you're still the highest-paid project manager in your own business. You can take a week off but not a month. The move is to buy back your time: come off the editing first (see [How to hire a video editor](#)), then the shooting, and spend the hours on positioning and relationships until at least one client treats you as a strategic adviser.

Guides: [How to choose a niche](#), [The one line that says who you help](#), [How to qualify a video lead before you pitch](#), [How to show real authority on a sales call](#), [Making your first hire](#), [Handling the imposter feeling](#), [Getting your weekends back](#), [Three real hours of work a day](#).

**Leverage: build systems so you're not the bottleneck**

Leverage is the constraint when you're leading the business, revenue is predictable and the business runs without daily heroics, but every decision still flows through your judgement. The move is to raise your price floor and hold it, and to set a weekly

leadership rhythm in which the team owns the day-to-day. Staying at current prices because they're working is the usual trap.

Guides: [When one big client owns your video business](#), [The marketing asset you already have](#).

### Expansion: scale into bigger projects with consistent revenue

Expansion is where the business grows without needing more of your time, the team runs autonomously, and revenue builds through reputation and referrals. At this point focus is the constraint. The question at this point is what not to do next: a new opportunity should add margin, not just volume.

Guides: [How to move from one-off projects to recurring revenue](#), [How to grow revenue from the clients you already have](#), [Case study: escaping the project treadmill](#).

## Where does the S.C.A.L.E. Method come from?

The S.C.A.L.E. Method comes from Den Lennie's 2026 book of the same name, and from eight years of coaching video production company owners through VBA. The book is at [denlennie.com/book](https://denlennie.com/book), and Den's other books are on [The books Den Lennie has written](#). How the coaching around the method works, and what it costs, is on [What VBA offers](#).



The field guides show you how the system works. The Boardroom is where I look at your business with you, give you perspective and judgement on what to do next, and hold you to it every week.

Last reviewed 8 October 2026. [denlennie.com](https://denlennie.com)

© 2026 Den Lennie. Free to read and use in your own business. Not for republishing or resale.